

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-06T18:24:34+00:00

Release: datasette 1.0a38 This release fixes a SQL injection security issue that affects Datasette instances that serve a mixture of public and private tables in the same database, with access configured using the Datasette permissions system . Site administrators who serve private tables in this way are advised to disable the execute-sql permission ' on that database to prevent users from accessing private tables using raw SQL queries. The bug that has been fixed would have allowed users with access to any public table to execute SQL injection attacks despite that restriction, giving them read-only access to data in private tables in the same database. This fix is also available in Datasette 0.65.3 . Thankfully this particular configuration - private tables and public tables exposed for the same database within the same instance - is likely to be rare. I've not encountered an instance like that myself. Tags: security , sql-injection , datasette

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-06T18:22:07+00:00

Release: datasette 0.65.3 Back-ported the SQL Injection security fix from 1.0a38 . Tags: datasette

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-06T18:04:39+00:00

<https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/6/simon-willison-on-technical-blogging/#atom-everything>  
Simon Willison on Technical Blogging I was interviewed by Cynthia Dunlop for her "Write that blog!" series back in January, but I just realized I never linked to the interview from my own blog! It includes my answers to the following questions: Why did you start blogging ? and why do you continue? What has been the most surprising impact of blogging for you? What blog post are you most proud of and why? What post was the most difficult to write and how did you tackle it? Any lessons learned that you want to share with the community? Your advice for people just getting started with blogging? A few blogs that you particularly enjoy? I'll repeat my most important piece of advice here: My number one tip for blogging is to lower your standards! Aim to hit publish while you are still actively unhappy with what you have written, because the only alternative is a huge folder full of drafts and never publishing anything at all. Nobody will ever know how perfect the thing you intended to write would have been. The flaws you see in your writing are invisible to everyone else. Tags: blogging , interviews

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-06T23:47:32Z

Mark Gurman, reporting for Bloomberg (gift link): OpenAI expects users to rely on the smart speaker throughout the day. It will work similarly to the company's ChatGPT voice mode on smartphone apps, but with more advanced models for humanlike interactivity. The device is designed to learn more about a user over time, letting it tailor conversations and act more like a real person. The circle-shaped device will include parts that move on their own, according to the people. That will help show when it's responding and interacting with the user. The goal is to make the object feel more alive than today's stationary speaker products.

The product will have speaker grills and microphones for fielding commands and conversing with users. The battery-powered item will be designed to work in different positions ? in a user?s hand, say, or placed on a nightstand or kitchen counter. OpenAI is also planning to include lights on the device to demonstrate when it?s listening and make interactions feel more personal. A camera system and other sensors, meanwhile, will perceive the surrounding environment and feed visual information into the AI. This doesn?t sound like a ?smart speaker? with lights...

#### 5. OpenAI Files 28-Page Motion to Dismiss Apple?s Lawsuit (PDF Link)

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-06T21:13:04Z

Link: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.cand.474095/gov.uscourts.cand.474095.59.0.pdf>

This is more like it. No mealy-mouthing or wishy-washiness here. This is a strident defense. I?ll quote just one line for now: Apple offers nothing because it has nothing because there is nothing. Its Complaint cannot and does not state a misappropriation claim against Defendant Tan. I?ll post more thoughts later, but if you?re following this lawsuit, you should read OpenAI?s motion yourself. It?s cogently written, not mired in legalese. Legalese is generally a sign of shitty lawyers. The law is meant to be practiced by lawyers, but understood by everyone. The law is not a priesthood; motions in a lawsuit are not holy texts reserved for the sainted few. What boggles my mind is that almost none of the outlets reporting on this today linked to OpenAI?s actual motion. (Kudos to Jess Weatherbed of The Verge, who did .) Summaries are necessary and commentary is good, but for chrissake link to the source document. ?

#### 6. Brendan Leonard: ?Do It 14,000 Times Slower With This One Trick?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-06T20:23:52Z

Link: <https://semi-rad.com/2026/08/do-it-14000-times-slower-with-this-one-trick/>

This comic from Brendan Leonard is a fine companion to yesterday?s items ( here and here ) on pausing to consider if our use of AI is helping us focus our time on what we love to do, or, instead, robbing us of the things that make us human. The bit about making a sandwich hit close enough to home for me to make me laugh aloud. ?

#### 7. Creating a fake agile wrapper that is technically agile but is not useful outside its home apartment, part 3

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 05 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260805-00/?p=112591>

Forcing an object into the global interface table. The post Creating a fake agile wrapper that is technically agile but is not useful outside its home apartment, part 3 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

#### 8. Canadian Man Pleads Guilty in Snowflake Extortions

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 06 Aug 2026 17:00:56 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/08/canadian-man-pleads-guilty-in-snowflake-extortions/>

A 26-year-old Canadian man once described as one of the most consequential cybercrime threat actors of 2024 has pleaded guilty to computer fraud and conspiracy to hack and extort more than 165 organizations that used the cloud data storage provider Snowflake. Connor Riley Moucka, of Kitchener, Ontario, also admitted to stealing call and text history records of more than 100 million AT&T customers.

#### 9. Zig's Io.Threaded is Neat

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-08-06T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/08/06/neat-io-threaded.html>

std.io.Threaded is one of the implementations of Zig's new Io interface that enables concurrency. This is a boring just use threads impl. I personally find it neat though --- it does this weird thing that I wanted to do for ages, that to my knowledge no one else is doing properly, and implements it better than I thought to be possible.

#### 10. Calculating log(1000!)

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 06 Aug 2026 13:23:43 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/06/log1000/>

The previous post pointed out that the following code such as the following unexpectedly works.

```
>>> from math import log, factorial >>> log(factorial(1000)) 5912.128178488163
```

If you don't find this unexpected, note that if you replace `math.log` with `numpy.log` the code will fail [1].

Functions like natural logarithm operate on real numbers. Real numbers are represented [?] The post Calculating log(1000!) first appeared on John D. Cook .

#### 11. SigV4 authentication is surprisingly complicated

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 06 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://www.tigrisdata.com/blog/sigv4/>

SigV4 looks simple: sign a request, check the signature. Then you implement canonicalization, clock skew, and a cache that isn't allowed to hold your key. Tigris is a drop-in replacement for AWS S3 (or GCS, anything S3API compatible). As such, we need to be fully compatible with both the mechanisms and semantics of S3 including the SigV4 authentication protocol . This is the lingua franca of authentication in the object storage landscape; even Google Cloud Storage has a way to enable SigV4 support so you can use existing applications against its object storage service. At first I thought that SigV4 was fairly simple. Clients sign requests, servers do the same work and make sure the result matches. The main sticking point is that the cryptography involved is symmetric cryptography, the kind where both parties need to have the same secrets. This makes some scaling issues weird, but we'll get into that in the future. Note This is only going to be talking about authentication (ensuring the identity of a remote client), not authorization (ensuring the client has the permission to do something). Authorization will come in the future for reasons that will become obvious when you see that...

#### 12. What Will the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act Do for Housing Supply?

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 06 Aug 2026 12:02:32 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/what-will-the-21st-century-road-to>

A few weeks ago the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act became law. This is an enormous housing bill that's been in the works for roughly a year ? I first discussed it on Statecraft back in 2025 ? and folks are optimistic that it will, per its description, ?increase the supply of housing in America.?

#### 13. The Contracting Circle

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Fri, 07 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/the-contracting-circle>

Why don't we believe LLMs are people?

#### 14. The Earnest Era Ends

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-08-06T18:19:21Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17404612/glen-hansard-passing-reflection>

When we lost Glen Hansard last week, his work still fresh and lively, it was a reminder that the world has changed more than we think it has.

#### 15. Pluralistic: Eternal Sloptember (06 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 06 Aug 2026 10:07:06 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/06/sin-is-when/>

Today's links Eternal Sloptember: Mark Zuckerberg and the fantasy of social media without socializing. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Delany x The Onion; Duran Duran x Second Life; Spammers x blog pings; Privacywashing v Doordash; Good ideas are popular. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em.

Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Eternal Sloptember (permalink) I'm sure that working in social media ? dealing with people as mass statistical abstractions ? is a cognitohazard, the sort of thing that could make anyone a little solipsistic, convinced that everyone else is a kind of stimulus-responding automaton lacking the interiority that you yourself experience. But when it comes to Mark Zuckerberg, I'm increasingly convinced that he didn't acquire his worldview through the self-inflicted brain damage of his long exposure to the back-end of a vast social media system. I think the causal arrow points in the other direction: I think that Zuck founded Facebook because he doesn't really...